



Vail Resort: Ski & Ride School Customer Segmentation

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Industry Partner: Vail Resorts

VR

KEY TAKEAWAY

*We identified **five key customer segments** by analyzing transaction behaviors of Vail Ski & Ride School Customers. This helps hone the **most personalized, valuable, and satisfying experiences**.*

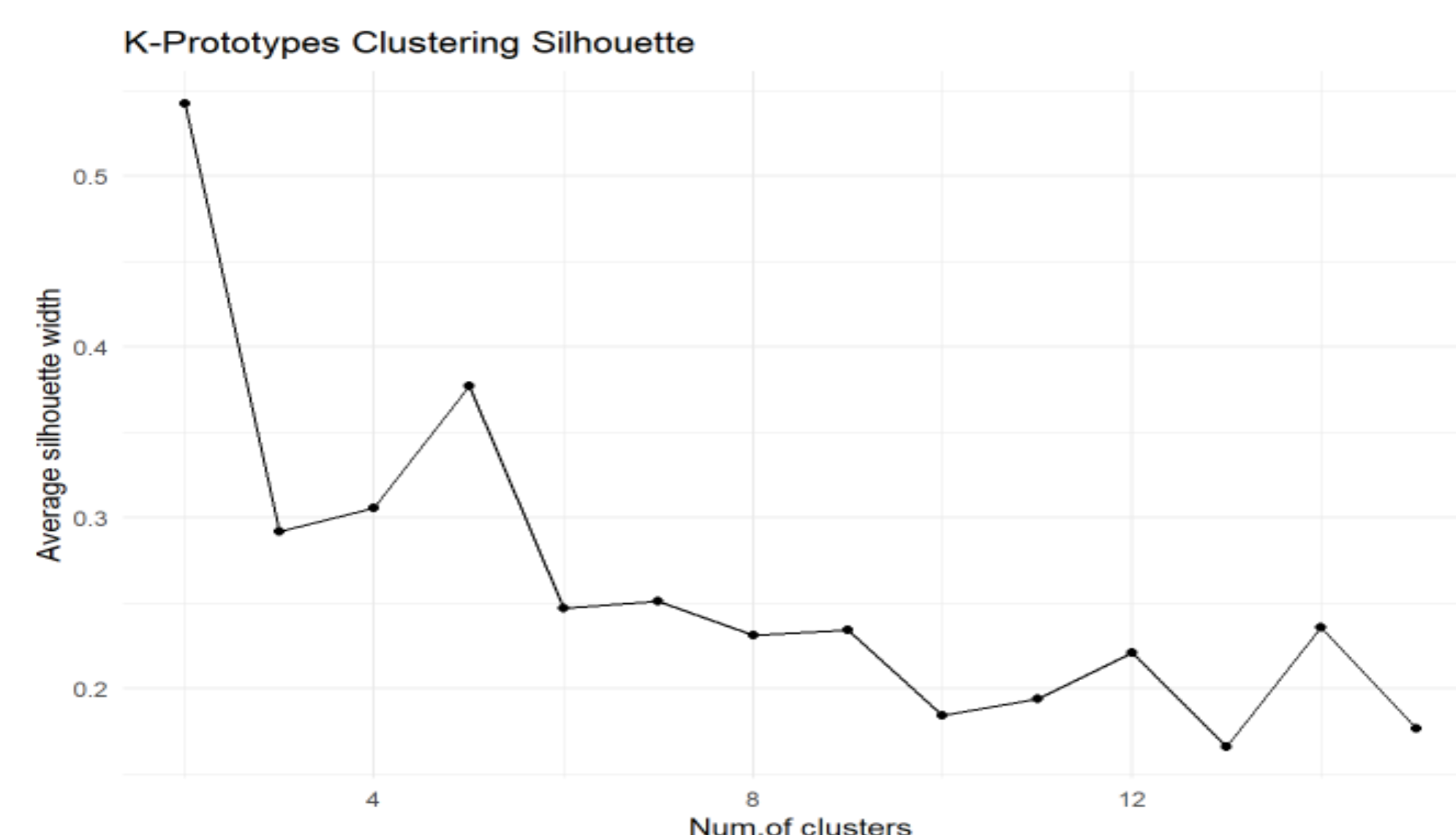
PROBLEM STATEMENT

- How can Vail Resorts create a more personalized experience for the Ski & Ride School customers
- Identify and create “customer profiles” of Vail’s ski class-taking customers for marketing purposes

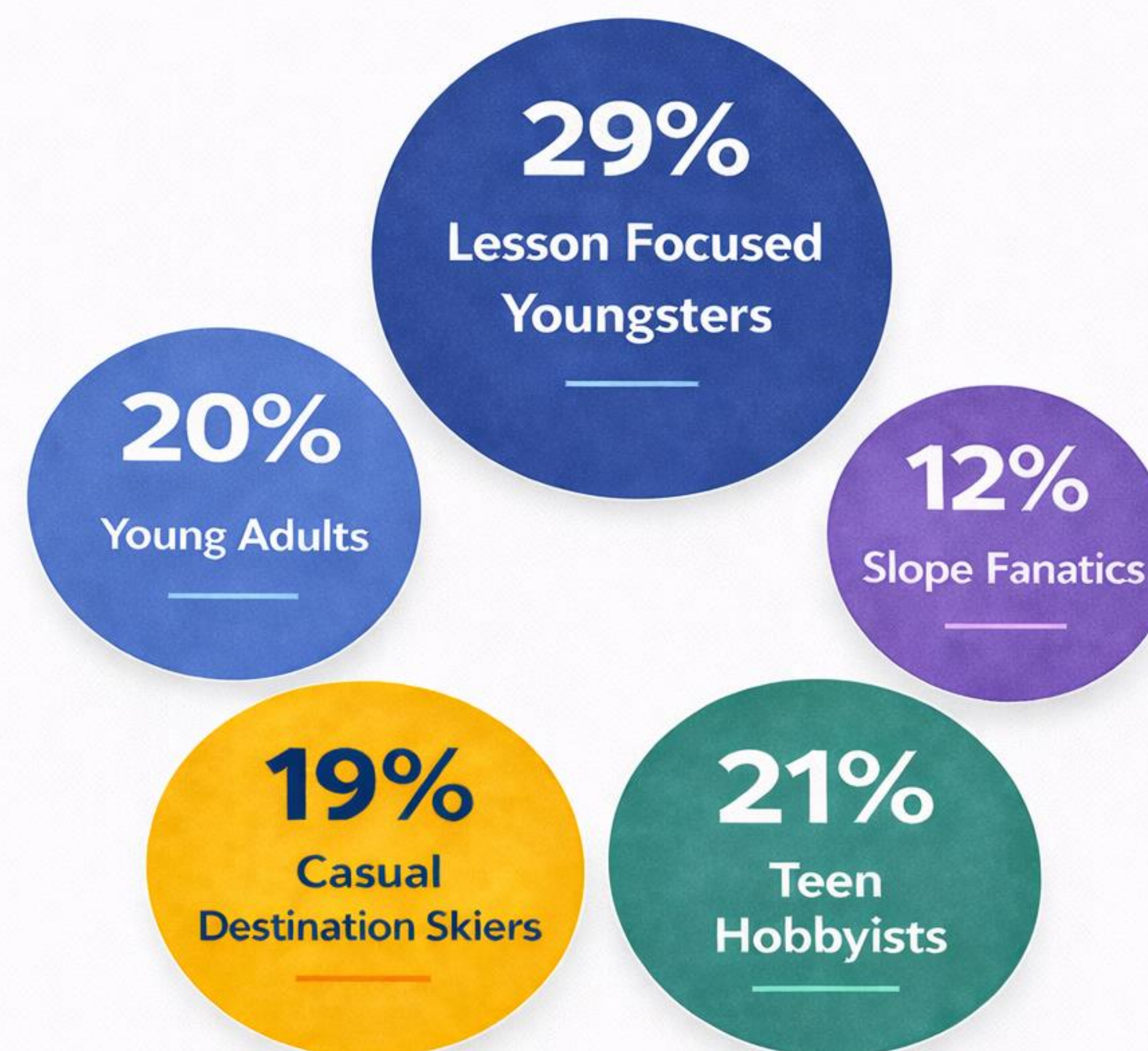
DATA & METHODOLOGY

Dataset: Transaction data with 75 million rows

1. Aggregate transaction data into customer-level features
2. Sampling 1 million customers from each fiscal year at the customer level to preserve the correct unit of analysis
3. K-prototype clustering applied to handle mixed categorical and numerical data
4. Five distinct customer segments identified



FINDINGS & RESULTS



Characteristic	Cluster 1	Cluster 2	Cluster 3	Cluster 4	Cluster 5
Class Type	Child	Child & Specialty	Adult	Adult & Private	Adult, Private, & Specialty
Age Range	Child to Tween	Teen	Young Adults	Middle-Aged	Teen to Elderly
Total Lesson Days (Avg)	2.49	4.72	1.50	1.69	3.11
Total Active Days (Avg)	2.85	9.21	3.55	3.29	12.37
Resort Diversity	1 Resort	1-2 Resorts	1 Resort	1 Resort	2+ Resorts
Sub-season Diversity	One Season of Intense Classes	Visits Across Several Seasons	One or Two Visits Per Year	One or Two Visits Per Year	Year-Round Visitor
Skill	Beginner	Intermediate	Beginner to Intermediate	Beginner to Intermediate	Advanced
Pass-Holder	Rarely	Most Years	Sometimes	Sometimes	Always

CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

“Lesson-Focused Youngsters”

Parent Enrolled Beginners, Lesson-Visits Only

“Teen Hobbyists”

Extracurricular Skiing, Pass-Variable, Class Enthusiast

“Young Adults”

Local Intermediates, Pass-Variable, Social Class-Takers

“Casual Destination Skiers”

Dual-Decade Ski Vacationer, Class-Shopper, Retired

“Slope Fanatics”

Advanced Mountain Experts, Young and Old

LIMITATIONS & CONCLUSIONS

- Due to computational constraints, we used sampling, which may introduce bias. We mitigated this through random sampling.
- We were limited to a more impersonal view of customers through data and did not have direct access to personal customer perspectives through interviewing. Profiles were based on data and theory.

These guest segments allow Vail Resorts to personalize every customer journey. Integrating these clusters across sales, marketing, and on-mountain operations ensures that every touchpoint is high-impact, allowing the Ski & Ride School to allocate budget toward high-conversion efforts that resonate with each guest's specific motivations.